🎬 Motion Buddy Quickstart Guide

Motion Buddy is your local AI assistant for Adobe After Effects. It turns your natural-language prompts into safe, validated scripts that execute directly in AE.

🚀 The 3-Step Workflow

Using Motion Buddy is a simple bridge between After Effects and your terminal. Here is the daily workflow:

1. Export Your AE Context

First, tell Motion Buddy what you're currently working on in After Effects.

- **In After Effects:** Run the script `after-effects/export-context.jsx`.
- *(This saves your active comp, selected layers, and camera info so Motion Buddy knows what to target).*

2. Prompt Motion Buddy

Next, tell Motion Buddy what you want to do using plain English.

- **In your Terminal:** Run the CLI with your prompt:

```
npm run dev -- --prompt "Offset all selected layers by 5 frames"
```

- **Review & Confirm:** The CLI will display a **Dry-Run Summary**, showing you exactly what it plans to do, the risks, and the generated code. If it looks correct, confirm the execution.

3. Apply the Script in AE

Finally, bring the generated animation or changes back into After Effects.

- **In After Effects:** Run the script `after-effects/import-generated-script.jsx`.
- *(This applies the changes to your project!)*

🛠️ Supported Actions

Motion Buddy natively supports several powerful actions out of the box:

- `offset_selected_layers`: Create stagger effects instantly.
- `convert_selected_layers_to_3d`: Quickly toggle 3D on multiple targets.
- `animate_overshoot_scale_on_selected_layers`: Add smooth pop-in animations.
- `ensure_camera` & `animate_camera_push`: Easily build camera rigs and movements.
- `create_shape_grid`: Generate perfect grids of shapes.
- `apply_palette_to_selected_layers`: Auto-color your design.

💡 Quick Tips

- **Dry-Run Only:** Just want to see what the AI *would* do without writing any files? Add `--dry-run` to your command: `npm run dev -- --prompt "Create a centered shape grid" --dry-run`
- **Logs & Debugging:** Every run is securely logged locally. If something goes wrong, you can always check your `.motion-buddy/logs/` folder to see the exact prompt and generated script.